

Hazrat Shuaib

Nabi Shuaib  was sent to *Madyan*. *Madyan* was the name of a certain tribe who was the offspring of Madeen, a son of Nabi Ibraheem .

Because Nabi Shuaib  also belonged to the same tribe, therefore after Nabi Shuaib was sent to them the tribe became known as the people of Shuaib.

Madyan and the People of Aikah

The Qur'ān has informed us of two things regarding this tribe, viz, firstly that they were resident on an open highway, plain for all to see and secondly that both they and the people of Loot  were situated on an open highway.

According to Arab Geography the road leading from Hijaz to Syria, Palestine and Yemen even as far as Egypt for travelling caravans and passing along the eastern shore of the Red Sea is called the plain highway. As for the term *Ashabul-Aykah*, th Arabic refers to the fertile green trees. After knowing these two things we say that Madeen's inhabitants lived on the Eastern shore on the last part of Arabia.

Some *Ulama* have made a distinction between *Madyan* and *Aykah*. But the correct verdict is this that both of them are one and the same people, which if one look at their father

is called *Madyan* and when looking at their Geographic situation is called *Ashabul-Aykah*.

Invitation to the Truth

When Nabi Shuaib ﷺ was sent to his people, he saw that the prevalence of sinful activities and disobedience was not only confined to some individuals but found that the whole nation was involved in a whirlpool of sin and evil and so deeply were they involved in their iniquitous acts that not for a moment were they realising that they were busy with sins. In fact they considered those deeds as deeds to be boastful of.

Apart from their other acts of disobedience they were especially involved in the following acts:

- (a) Idol worship and polytheistic customs and beliefs.
- (b) In business and trade they were guilty of taking full payment and not giving full measure or weight.
- (c) In all affairs they were guilty of fraud and deceit as well as highway robbery.

According to the general habit of nations, their comfortable life style and their life of plenty, their abundance of wealth and the fertility of their lands and abundance of greenery and moisture made them so proud and arrogant that they looked upon all these things as their own as a result of their own efforts and not for a moment did it enter their minds that all these favours were from Allah and that they have to express gratitude to him for all that. In fact their unmindfulness was the evil that caused numerous faults among them.

Finally Allah reacted and according to His *Sunnat* and in order to show them the correct path, Allah chose one from among themselves with the purpose of saving

them from evil and making God-fearing and sent him to them as a Prophet and Messenger. In this way Nabi Shuaib  was sent to them.

He conveyed to them the message of Allah's oneness and to avoid all forms of '*Shirk*' and idol worship as was the general message of all Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*). At the same time he had to concentrate on the specific evil deeds of his people and place special emphasis on their social affairs and preached to them on honesty in their affairs.

When Hazrat Shuaib  looked at his people's evil deeds he was greatly pained and in giving them admonition towards guidance, called them to the same things to which the previous Prophets called their peoples. He said to them:

"O people, worship one Allah. no one else is worthy of worship and in your trade affairs be honest and give full measure Do not deceive people in your dealings with them. Uptill yesterday it is possible that I may have been unaware of your deeds. But today Allah's argument against you have come. Now you are no more excused and neither are your going to be pardoned for those deeds. Accept the truth and avoid all falsehood and evil that is the way towards success. Do not commit any mischief in Allah's lands now that Allah has prepared all its means towards righteous ness. If there is *Imān* and *Yaqeen* in you, then this is the way for you. Do not sit along the highways with the aim of robbing people and do not threaten the one who is bent upon following the right path.

O people! Remember Allah's favours upon you. You were but few and He increased your numbers.

O my people! Just think about these people before you who sought to commit evil in the land, how dreadful was their ending! And if one group of you believe in me and another group does not, the matter does not end there. Wait with patience until Allah passes judgment between us. He is the best Judge."

Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام was a very eloquent speaker with a sweet tongue and a strong style of expression, for this reason the *Mufasssireen* have named him the *Khateeb* among the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*).

He used sweet words and hard words to call his people to guidance but unfortunately his words had no effect upon them. Apart from a few weak and poor ones no one else would listen to him. They continued on their evil ways and continued to mislead others. In fact they sat along the way to intercept those wanting to come to him, encouraging them to steer clear of Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام. If they found the chance they resorted to robbing people and if and when someone came so far as to accept the truth they threatened him. But in spite of all that Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام continued his mission. Then those who were proud of their high position among the people, said to him:

"O Shuaib, one out of two things will surely come to pass: Either will we expel you and those who believe in you from our town or we will force you to return to our religion."

Shuaib عليه السلام replied: "If we consider your religion wrong and false and are forced to follow it, that will be a great injustice. And seeing that Allah had saved us from your religion and if we are to return to it, it will mean we have spoke an untruth and fabricated a lie against Allah. This is impossible. But if Allah wants anything he does what He wishes. His knowledge is hidden over all things. We only rely on Him."

O Lord, Judge between us and our people with truth. You are the best Judge.

When the leaders of the people saw the resolute manner of his reply, they turned away and said to the people:

"Behold, If you obeyed Shuaib, you will be destroyed."

Shuaib also said: "Allah has sent me that I may use all my powers to rectify your lives. And whatever I say to you, I bring to you Allah's proof for that, But alas! You see these clear signs and still remain on your disobedient and rebellious ways and there is not one form of opposition which you have discarded. And yet I do not ask of you any payment for the message of guidance I bring to you; and I seek not from you any worldly benefit there from. My reward lies only with Allah. If now you fail to heed my call, I am afraid and fear the coming of punishment which will destroy you. The decree has been passed and nothing will turn it away or direct it from your side.

With a frown on their fore heads from displeasures the leaders of the nation turned away and said:

"O Shuaib! Does your *Salaah* desire from us that we should leave aside worshipping the gods of our fore fathers and we should not have

the right to do with our wealth as we see fit. If we are going to discard giving small measure in our trade dealings and if we are going to stop unfair dealings in business, and deceiving clients, we will become bankrupt and poor. In the light of such teachings can one of us look upon you as a true guide?

Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام replied in a passion manner and with love:

"O people, I fear that your fearlessness and your disobedience against Allah will bring the same results which before now happened to the people of Nooh, Hood, Saulih and Loot (*Alaihimus Salām*)."

Still nothing happened positively. He continued:

"O people, bend down before Allah and seek forgiveness from Him for your sins. Repent to Him. He is Merciful and He will forgive your sins."

Hearing this the chiefs and leaders replied:

"O Shuaib, we do not understand what you say. You are the weakest and poorest among us. If what you say is true then your position would be so much better than ours. We only fear for your family and tribe, otherwise we would stone you to death so that you will not be successful over us."

Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام replied:

"Alas! Is my family and tribe more to be feared than Allah. And after all Allah knows all your deeds good and bad and is all knowing all seeing."

But if still you will not listen to my please, you can continue what you do now, but Allah will show His judgement as to who is more fitting to receive His punishment and who is untrue in his speech. You wait for it. I too will wait for it."

At last that happened which is Allah's everlasting Law. That is after he had sent His arguments and Proofs, if the people still insist in their evil deeds, jeering at the truth, becoming an obstacle in the spread of the truth, Allah's punishment came to put on end to life of iniquity and evil. And so He made them a warning sign for coming generation.

The Sort of Punishment

The Qur'ān states that the people of Nabi Shuaib  were made to suffer two types of punishment One, was an earthquake and two, a fire raining down on them from the skies.

While they were comforebly in their homes a dressed ful earth quake shook the earth suddenly and before its effect wore off fire started raining down on them. The result was that the next morning observers saw the erst while arrogant and disobedient people were lying down with their faces to the ground. The Qur'ān states:

"So the earthquake took them unawares and they lay prostrate in their homes in the morning."
(7:78)

And:

"Then the punishment of a day of over shadowing gloom seized them, and that was the penalty of a great day."
(26:189)

The Grave of Hazrat Shuaib عليه السلام

In Hadramaut there is a grave which the inhabitants claim is the grave of Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام who came to settle there after the destruction of madyan. It is said he passed away here.

Lessons and Warnings

1. In Islam the rights of other human beings, correct social relations, honesty in dealings and trustworthiness are considered of such importance that Allah should send a special messenger with the purpose of correcting wrong actions in this field.
2. To fail to give another his full measure in business is such illness that as a bad character trait will increase and increase that it will cause the bad point of destroying the rights of others, thereby causing the cutting off of honour and respect as well as mutual relations of love and brotherhood, and making place for such evils as greed, selfishness, envy and jealousy.
3. To give correct measure is not only confined to the buying and selling of commodities. But the human beings character should be such that in his dealings with other persons he should endeavour to live up to all their rights and responsibilities towards them, and deal with them with complete justice.
4. To avoid dishonesty in weighing and measuring and to practise justice is a test for man's dealings with others, because he who does not take precaution in such small matters how can he be trusted in major worldly and spiritual matters.

5. There is no crime so great as to commit evil in the land after it has been fully rectified. That is the basis of such evils as injustice, arrogance and murder and attacking people's character.
6. From a study of the lives of the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and their true followers we see that the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) brought clear arguments, showed Allah's special signs and invited to His ways with love and mercy and yet did not demand any reward from their people. Yet in response to that it has always been a reply that "we will stone you to death," "we will kill you." In fact they were not even prepared to accept the presence of the Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) among them. And in the end there was also the challenge of "bring forth the punishment with which you threaten us."
7. That normally is the last step in the story after which Allah's Law of Retribution comes into operation, whereby the rebellious, arrogant and evil-doing people are punished and destroyed to become a lesson for coming generations.

Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام in the Qur'ān

The story of Nabi Shuaib عليه السلام and his people is told in *Surah A'raaf*, *Surah Hood* and in *Shu'araa* with somewhat of detail. In *Surah Hijr* and *Ankabut* it is mentioned concisely.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

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P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa